**PEW RESEARCH CENTER**
**AUGUST 11-14, 2011 OMNIBUS**
**FINAL TOPLINE**
**N=1,005**

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. Recent ups and downs in the stock market | | | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 32 | 28 | 16 | 24 | 1 |
| July 28-31, 2011 | 18 | 23 | 20 | 39 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011: *Recent gains in the stock market* | 13 | 17 | 20 | 49 | 1 |
| August 12-15, 2010: *Recent ups and downs in the stock market* | 17 | 21 | 20 | 42 | 1 |
| March 26-29, 2010 | 13 | 23 | 23 | 40 | 1 |
| October 16-19, 2009: *Recent gains in the stock market* | 15 | 23 | 19 | 43 | * |
| July 24-27, 2009 | 23 | 25 | 24 | 28 | * |
| March 13-16, 2009 | 38 | 31 | 14 | 17 | 0 |
| March 6-9, 2009: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market* | 35 | 31 | 15 | 19 | * |
| February 20-23, 2009 | 31 | 32 | 20 | 17 | * |
| November 21-24, 2008 | 50 | 23 | 15 | 12 | * |
| October 17-20, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market* | 54 | 31 | 9 | 6 | * |
| October 10-13, 2008: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market* | 59 | 26 | 9 | 6 | * |
| July 3-7, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market* | 22 | 29 | 23 | 26 | * |
| March 14-17, 2008 | 25 | 31 | 23 | 21 | * |
| January 25-28, 2008 | 29 | 28 | 19 | 23 | 1 |
| August 17-20, 2007 | 21 | 24 | 22 | 33 | * |
| July 27-30, 2007 | 15 | 26 | 21 | 37 | 1 |
| March 2-5, 2007: *The recent drop in the U.S. stock market* | 21 | 28 | 25 | 26 | * |
| Early September, 2002: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market* | 27 | 30 | 20 | 22 | 1 |
| Late July, 2002 | 33 | 33 | 15 | 18 | 1 |
| March, 2001 | 27 | 27 | 18 | 27 | 1 |
| Mid-October, 2000 | 20 | 26 | 23 | 31 | 1 |
| April, 2000 | 18 | 28 | 23 | 31 | * |
| Early April, 2000 | 19 | 29 | 20 | 32 | * |
| March, 2000 | 23 | 29 | 21 | 26 | 1 |
| March, 1999 | 18 | 29 | 22 | 31 | * |
| January, 1999 | 24 | 28 | 19 | 28 | 1 |
| Early September, 1998 | 32 | 31 | 20 | 17 | * |
| Mid-August, 1998 | 17 | 23 | 21 | 39 | * |
| January, 1998 | 21 | 25 | 23 | 31 | * |
| Mid-November, 1997 | 25 | 36 | 18 | 20 | 1 |
| Early November, 1997: *Thinking about last Monday when the stock market dropped, how closely did you follow what was happening?* | 16 | 29 | 22 | 33 | * |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | (VOL.) DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| September, 1997: *Recent major ups and downs in the stock market* | 14 | 22 | 23 | 40 | 1 |
| April, 1997 | 17 | 21 | 22 | 40 | * |
| February, 1996 | 12 | 20 | 25 | 42 | 1 |
| b. Severe food shortages in Somalia | | | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 15 | 23 | 22 | 39 | 1 |
| August 4-7, 2011 | 12 | 21 | 26 | 40 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| April 25-28, 2008: *Reports about a worldwide food shortage* | 24 | 33 | 12 | 11 | 1 |
| April 18-21, 2008 | 14 | 25 | 25 | 34 | 2 |
| October, 1993: *The situation in Somalia* | 34 | 41 | 16 | 8 | 1 |
| September, 1993 | 20 | 42 | 26 | 12 | * |
| February, 1993: *Accounts about U.S. troops in Somalia* | 28 | 42 | 22 | 8 | * |
| January, 1993: *The deployment of U.S. forces to Somalia* | 52 | 37 | 8 | 3 | * |
| September, 1992: *The civil war and famine in Somalia* | 11 | 24 | 31 | 33 | 1 |
| c. The 30 U.S. troops killed in Afghanistan in a helicopter attack | | | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 39 | 33 | 13 | 14 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| June 30-July 3, 2011: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan* | 22 | 34 | 24 | 20 | 1 |
| June 23-26, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about U.S. troop levels in Afghanistan* | 27 | 32 | 20 | 20 | 1 |
| June 2-5, 2011: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan* | 20 | 35 | 23 | 21 | 1 |
| March 3-6, 2011: *U.S. airmen killed at an airport in Frankfort, Germany* | 16 | 22 | 19 | 42 | 1 |
| December 16-19, 2010: *The Obama administration's review of the Afghanistan war strategy* | 17 | 26 | 25 | 31 | 1 |
| December 9-12, 2010: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan* | 24 | 31 | 22 | 22 | 1 |
| November 18-21, 2010 | 27 | 33 | 21 | 18 | 1 |
| October 21-24, 2010 | 21 | 34 | 23 | 21 | 1 |
| October 7-10, 2010 | 21 | 36 | 20 | 22 | 1 |
| September 30-October 3, 2010 | 23 | 37 | 23 | 15 | 1 |
| September 23-26, 2010 | 29 | 40 | 19 | 11 | 1 |
| September 9-12, 2010 | 30 | 33 | 20 | 17 | * |
| July 29-August 1, 2010 | 34 | 35 | 22 | 9 | * |
| July 15-18, 2010 | 22 | 33 | 23 | 22 | * |
| July 8-11, 2010 | 23 | 32 | 24 | 20 | 1 |
| July 1-5, 2010 | 29 | 34 | 23 | 14 | 1 |
| June 17-20, 2010 | 21 | 30 | 27 | 22 | * |
| May 20-23, 2010 | 22 | 33 | 25 | 20 | * |
| April 9-12, 2010 | 21 | 29 | 27 | 22 | 1 |
| June 24-27, 2010: *General Stanley McChrystal resigning as head of U.S. forces in Afghanistan after being quoted criticizing President Obama and his Afghanistan strategy* | 28 | 31 | 19 | 21 | 1 |
| February 19-22, 2010: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan* | 24 | 36 | 21 | 19 | * |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| January 8-11, 2010: S*uicide bombing that killed seven Americans at a CIA base in Afghanistan* | 24 | 31 | 27 | 17 | 1 |
| December 11-14, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan* | 35 | 33 | 18 | 13 | * |
| December 4-7, 2009: *President Obama's decision to send more U.S. troops to Afghanistan* | 43 | 33 | 14 | 8 | 1 |
| November 20-23, 2009: *The debate over whether to send more troops to Afghanistan* | 29 | 31 | 17 | 22 | 1 |
| November 13-16, 2009 | 29 | 28 | 20 | 22 | 1 |
| November 6-9, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan* | 22 | 35 | 24 | 18 | * |
| October 30-November 2, 2009 | 24 | 32 | 21 | 22 | * |
| October 23-26, 2009 | 32 | 29 | 21 | 18 | * |
| October 16-19, 2009 | 25 | 31 | 20 | 24 | * |
| September 25-28, 2009: *The debate over whether to send more troops to Afghanistan* | 27 | 40 | 17 | 16 | * |
| September 18-21, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan* | 26 | 33 | 25 | 16 | * |
| September 11-14, 2009 | 25 | 35 | 22 | 18 | 1 |
| September 3-6, 2009 | 23 | 33 | 23 | 21 | 0 |
| August 7-10, 2009 | 24 | 32 | 23 | 21 | 1 |
| March 20-23, 2009 | 24 | 32 | 22 | 22 | * |
| February 20-23, 2009: *The Obama administration's decision to send 17,000 additional U.S. troops to Afghanistan* | 27 | 29 | 24 | 19 | 1 |
| January 30-February 2, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan* | 26 | 34 | 24 | 16 | * |
| January 2-4, 2009 | 22 | 33 | 23 | 21 | 1 |
| October 24-27, 2008 | 28 | 32 | 22 | 17 | 1 |
| October 10-13, 2008: *The military effort in Afghanistan against Taliban fighters* | 19 | 34 | 29 | 18 | * |
| September 12-15, 2008 | 21 | 34 | 25 | 19 | 1 |
| August 29-31, 2008 | 18 | 27 | 32 | 23 | * |
| July 18-21, 2008 | 27 | 33 | 24 | 16 | * |
| July 11-14, 2008 | 19 | 28 | 29 | 23 | 1 |
| July 3-7, 2008 | 19 | 28 | 32 | 21 | * |
| June 20-23, 2008 | 20 | 30 | 30 | 20 | * |
| Late July, 2002: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan* | 41 | 38 | 13 | 7 | 1 |
| June, 2002 | 38 | 32 | 20 | 9 | 1 |
| April, 2002 | 39 | 39 | 13 | 8 | 1 |
| Early April, 2002 | 45 | 37 | 12 | 5 | 1 |
| February, 2002 | 47 | 39 | 8 | 5 | 1 |
| January, 2002 | 51 | 35 | 9 | 4 | 1 |
| December, 2001 | 44 | 38 | 12 | 5 | 1 |
| Mid-November, 2001 | 49 | 36 | 11 | 3 | 1 |
| Early November, 2001 | 45 | 36 | 12 | 6 | 1 |
| Mid-October, 2001 | 51 | 35 | 10 | 3 | 1 |
| d. Riots in London and other parts of Britain | | | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 17 | 28 | 21 | 32 | 1 |
| **TREND FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| June 30-July 3, 2011: *The financial crisis and violent protests in Greece* | 14 | 22 | 23 | 39 | 1 |
| June 16-19, 2011 | 10 | 20 | 25 | 45 | * |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| May 7-10, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece and violent protests there* | 19 | 23 | 26 | 31 | * |
| April 30-May 3, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece* | 6 | 15 | 28 | 51 | 1 |
| e. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections | | | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 19 | 24 | 20 | 36 | 1 |
| August 4-7, 2011 | 18 | 21 | 22 | 37 | 1 |
| July 28-31, 2011 | 17 | 27 | 21 | 35 | 1 |
| July 21-24, 2011 | 17 | 22 | 28 | 32 | * |
| July 14-17, 2011 | 18 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 1 |
| July 7-10, 2011 | 16 | 23 | 27 | 33 | 1 |
| June 30-July 3, 2011 | 21 | 28 | 24 | 25 | 2 |
| June 23-26, 2011 | 19 | 26 | 24 | 31 | * |
| June 16-19, 2011 | 23 | 29 | 23 | 25 | * |
| June 9-12, 2011 | 18 | 30 | 22 | 30 | 1 |
| June 2-5, 2011 | 21 | 31 | 22 | 26 | * |
| May 26-29, 2011 | 20 | 27 | 24 | 28 | * |
| May 19-22, 2011 | 15 | 27 | 24 | 32 | 1 |
| May 12-15, 2011 | 15 | 22 | 26 | 35 | 1 |
| May 5-8, 2011 | 16 | 24 | 27 | 32 | 1 |
| April 21-25, 2011 | 18 | 26 | 23 | 32 | 1 |
| April 14-17, 2011 | 20 | 23 | 29 | 27 | 1 |
| March 24-27, 2011 | 13 | 19 | 26 | 41 | 1 |
| March 10-13, 2011 | 15 | 21 | 26 | 38 | 0 |
| February 10-13, 2011 | 16 | 19 | 24 | 40 | * |
| February 3-6, 2011 | 15 | 20 | 23 | 42 | * |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| **2008 Election** | | | | | |
| October 31-November 3, 2008: *News about the presidential election* | 57 | 29 | 9 | 5 | * |
| October 24-27, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election* | 44 | 36 | 11 | 8 | 1 |
| October 17-20, 2008 | 61 | 28 | 7 | 4 | * |
| October 10-13, 2008 | 52 | 31 | 12 | 5 | * |
| October 3-6, 2008 | 57 | 31 | 8 | 4 | * |
| September 26-29, 2008 | 56 | 29 | 10 | 5 | * |
| September 19-22, 2008 | 47 | 33 | 14 | 6 | * |
| September 12-15, 2008 | 40 | 38 | 14 | 7 | 1 |
| September 5-8, 2008 | 45 | 39 | 12 | 4 | * |
| August 29-31, 2008 | 45 | 32 | 15 | 8 | * |
| August 22-25, 2008 | 31 | 36 | 22 | 11 | * |
| August 15-18, 2008 | 25 | 41 | 19 | 14 | 1 |
| August 8-11, 2008 | 27 | 38 | 22 | 13 | * |
| August 1-4, 2008 | 30 | 42 | 19 | 9 | * |
| July 25-28, 2008 | 30 | 34 | 21 | 15 | * |
| July 18-21, 2008 | 30 | 35 | 21 | 14 | * |
| July 11-14, 2008 | 28 | 34 | 22 | 15 | 1 |
| July 3-7, 2008 | 25 | 35 | 23 | 17 | * |
| June 27-30, 2008 | 39 | 33 | 18 | 10 | * |
| June 20-23, 2008 | 28 | 38 | 22 | 12 | * |
| June 13-16, 2008 | 35 | 35 | 20 | 10 | * |
| June 6-9, 2008 | 38 | 35 | 17 | 10 | * |
| May 30-June 2, 2008 | 30 | 35 | 21 | 14 | * |
| May 22-25, 2008 | 32 | 37 | 20 | 11 | * |
| May 16-19, 2008 | 33 | 37 | 19 | 10 | 1 |
| May 9-12, 2008 | 35 | 36 | 18 | 11 | * |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| May 2-5, 2008 | 27 | 35 | 23 | 14 | 1 |
| April 25-28, 2008 | 34 | 37 | 18 | 11 | * |
| April 18-21, 2008 | 29 | 41 | 19 | 10 | 1 |
| April 11-14, 2008 | 31 | 37 | 22 | 10 | * |
| April 4-7, 2008 | 33 | 36 | 17 | 14 | * |
| March 28-31, 2008 | 31 | 41 | 18 | 10 | * |
| March 20-24, 2008 | 34 | 37 | 18 | 11 | * |
| March 14-17, 2008 | 40 | 37 | 16 | 7 | * |
| March 7-10, 2008 | 39 | 36 | 15 | 9 | 1 |
| February 29-March 3, 2008 | 43 | 34 | 14 | 9 | * |
| February 22-25, 2008 | 42 | 37 | 13 | 8 | * |
| February 15-18, 2008 | 44 | 36 | 10 | 10 | * |
| February 8-11, 2008 | 39 | 37 | 15 | 9 | 0 |
| February 1-4, 2008 | 37 | 35 | 16 | 12 | * |
| January 25-28, 2008 | 36 | 37 | 14 | 12 | 1 |
| January 18-21, 2008 | 36 | 34 | 18 | 12 | * |
| January 11-14, 2008: *News about the New Hampshire primaries and the presidential campaign* | 32 | 31 | 19 | 17 | 1 |
| January 4-7, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election* | 33 | 36 | 19 | 11 | 1 |
| December 14-17, 2007 | 25 | 34 | 22 | 19 | * |
| December 7-10, 2007 | 24 | 35 | 22 | 19 | * |
| November 30 – December 3, 2007 | 23 | 35 | 23 | 19 | * |
| November 23-26, 2007 | 20 | 33 | 26 | 20 | 1 |
| November 16-19, 2007 | 26 | 33 | 21 | 19 | 1 |
| November 9-12, 2007 | 21 | 33 | 25 | 21 | * |
| November 2-5, 2007 | 27 | 30 | 21 | 21 | 1 |
| October 26-29, 2007 | 21 | 34 | 26 | 19 | * |
| October 19-22, 2007 | 23 | 32 | 22 | 23 | * |
| October 12-15, 2007 | 13 | 31 | 26 | 30 | * |
| October 5-8, 2007 | 22 | 30 | 24 | 24 | * |
| September 28 – October 1, 2007 | 21 | 34 | 25 | 20 | * |
| September 21-24, 2007 | 24 | 31 | 22 | 23 | * |
| September 14-17, 2007 | 22 | 31 | 24 | 23 | * |
| September 7-10, 2007 | 18 | 34 | 26 | 22 | * |
| August 30-September 2, 2007 | 19 | 35 | 21 | 25 | * |
| August 24-27, 2007 | 22 | 28 | 24 | 26 | * |
| August 17-20, 2007 | 19 | 27 | 24 | 30 | * |
| August 10-13, 2007 | 23 | 32 | 21 | 24 | * |
| August 3-6, 2007 | 19 | 31 | 25 | 25 | * |
| July 27-30, 2007 | 19 | 32 | 22 | 26 | 1 |
| July 20-23, 2007 | 16 | 26 | 30 | 27 | 1 |
| July 13-16, 2007 | 17 | 29 | 27 | 27 | * |
| July 6-9, 2007 | 24 | 29 | 24 | 22 | 1 |
| June 29-July 2, 2007 | 20 | 32 | 25 | 23 | * |
| June 22-25, 2007 | 18 | 31 | 21 | 30 | * |
| June 15-18, 2007 | 17 | 32 | 26 | 25 | * |
| June 8-11, 2007 | 19 | 30 | 24 | 26 | 1 |
| June 1-4, 2007 | 16 | 27 | 32 | 24 | 1 |
| May 24-27, 2007 | 22 | 33 | 23 | 22 | * |
| May 18-21, 2007 | 18 | 31 | 24 | 27 | * |
| May 11-14, 2007 | 18 | 30 | 23 | 28 | 1 |
| May 4-7, 2007 | 23 | 34 | 21 | 21 | 1 |
| April 27-30, 2007 | 14 | 30 | 29 | 26 | 1 |
| April 20-23, 2007 | 18 | 28 | 27 | 27 | * |
| April 12-16, 2007 | 18 | 28 | 27 | 27 | * |
| April 5-9, 2007 | 25 | 30 | 26 | 19 | * |
| March 30-April 2, 2007 | 20 | 29 | 27 | 23 | 1 |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED...**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| March 23-26, 2007 | 20 | 32 | 22 | 26 | * |
| March 16-19, 2007 | 15 | 28 | 29 | 27 | 1 |
| March 9-12, 2007 | 24 | 30 | 23 | 23 | * |
| March 2-5, 2007 | 19 | 31 | 26 | 23 | 1 |
| February 23-26, 2007 | 22 | 33 | 24 | 21 | * |
| February 16-19, 2007 | 18 | 32 | 22 | 27 | 1 |
| February 9-12, 2007 | 24 | 30 | 24 | 21 | 1 |
| February 2-5, 2007 | 24 | 36 | 22 | 18 | * |
| January 26-29, 2007 | 24 | 33 | 23 | 20 | * |
| January 19-22, 2007: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2008* | 24 | 27 | 22 | 26 | 1 |
| **2004 Election** | | | | | |
| November, 2004: *News about the presidential election* | 47 | 35 | 10 | 7 | 1 |
| Mid-October, 2004: *News about candidates for the 2004 presidential election* | 46 | 30 | 12 | 11 | 1 |
| September, 2004 | 40 | 34 | 14 | 11 | 1 |
| August, 2004 | 32 | 38 | 16 | 14 | * |
| July, 2004 | 29 | 37 | 18 | 15 | 1 |
| June, 2004 | 28 | 34 | 19 | 18 | 1 |
| April, 2004 | 31 | 33 | 19 | 16 | 1 |
| Mid-March, 2004 | 35 | 34 | 18 | 13 | * |
| Late February, 2004 **(GAP)** | 24 | 40 | 23 | 12 | 1 |
| Early February, 2004: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination* | 29 | 37 | 20 | 13 | 1 |
| Mid-January, 2004 | 16 | 30 | 27 | 26 | 1 |
| Early January, 2004 | 14 | 32 | 30 | 23 | 1 |
| December, 2003 | 16 | 26 | 27 | 30 | 1 |
| November, 2003 | 11 | 26 | 34 | 28 | 1 |
| October, 2003 | 12 | 27 | 28 | 32 | 1 |
| September, 2003 | 17 | 25 | 30 | 27 | 1 |
| Mid-August, 2003 | 12 | 27 | 27 | 33 | 1 |
| May, 2003 | 8 | 19 | 31 | 41 | 1 |
| January, 2003: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2004* | 14 | 28 | 29 | 28 | 1 |
| **2000 Election** | | | | | |
| Early November, 2000: *News about the presidential election* | 33 | 41 | 15 | 10 | 1 |
| Mid-October, 2000: *News about the presidential election campaign* | 36 | 35 | 17 | 11 | 1 |
| Early October, 2000 | 35 | 35 | 19 | 10 | 1 |
| September, 2000 | 22 | 42 | 21 | 15 | 1 |
| July, 2000: *News about candidates for the 2000 presidential election* | 21 | 38 | 20 | 20 | 1 |
| June, 2000 | 23 | 32 | 23 | 21 | 1 |
| May, 2000 | 18 | 33 | 26 | 23 | * |
| April, 2000 | 18 | 39 | 22 | 20 | 1 |
| Early April, 2000 | | | | | |
| March, 2000 | 26 | 41 | 19 | 13 | 1 |
| February, 2000 | 26 | 36 | 21 | 17 | * |
| January, 2000 | 19 | 34 | 28 | 18 | 1 |
| December, 1999 | 16 | 36 | 24 | 23 | 1 |
| October, 1999 | 17 | 32 | 28 | 22 | 1 |
| September, 1999 | 15 | 31 | 33 | 20 | 1 |
| July, 1999 | 15 | 38 | 24 | 22 | 1 |
| June, 1999 | 11 | 25 | 29 | 34 | 1 |
| **1996 Election** | | | | | |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| November, 1996: *News about the presidential election* | 28 | 42 | 19 | 10 | * |
| October, 1996: *News about the presidential election campaign* | 31 | 39 | 18 | 12 | * |
| Early September, 1996 | 24 | 36 | 23 | 17 | * |
| July, 1996 | 22 | 40 | 23 | 14 | 1 |
| April, 1996 | 23 | 35 | 25 | 17 | * |
| March, 1996 *News about the Republican presidential candidates* | 26 | 41 | 20 | 13 | * |
| January, 1996 | 10 | 34 | 31 | 24 | 1 |
| October, 1995 | 12 | 36 | 30 | 22 | * |
| August, 1995 | 13 | 34 | 28 | 25 | * |
| June, 1995 | 11 | 31 | 31 | 26 | 1 |
| **1992 Election** | | | | | |
| October, 1992: *News about the presidential election (RVs)* | 55 | 36 | 8 | 2 | 0 |
| September, 1992: *News about the presidential election campaign* | 42 | 37 | 13 | 8 | * |
| August, 1992: *News about the presidential election* (RVs) | 36 | 51 | 11 | 2 | 0 |
| July, 1992: *News about the presidential campaign* | 20 | 45 | 26 | 9 | * |
| May, 1992: *The presidential election campaign* | 32 | 44 | 16 | 8 | * |
| March, 1992: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination* | 35 | 40 | 16 | 9 | * |
| March, 1992: *The race for the Republican presidential nomination* | 25 | 40 | 22 | 13 | 1 |
| February 1992: *The Democratic primary in New Hampshire* | 19 | 31 | 26 | 24 | * |
| February, 1992: *The Republican primary in New Hampshire* | 19 | 31 | 26 | 23 | 1 |
| January, 1992: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination* | 11 | 25 | 36 | 27 | 1 |
| December, 1991 | 10 | 28 | 32 | 30 | * |
| October, 1991 | 12 | 26 | 31 | 29 | 2 |
| **1988 Election** | | | | | |
| October, 1988: *News about the presidential campaign in 1988* (RVs) | 43 | 44 | 11 | 2 | * |
| August, 1988 (RVs) | 39 | 45 | 13 | 3 | * |
| May, 1988 (RVs) | 22 | 46 | 23 | 6 | 3 |
| November, 1987: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination* | 15 | 28 | 35 | 21 | 1 |
| November, 1987: *News about the Republican candidates for the presidential nomination* | 13 | 28 | 36 | 22 | 1 |
| September, 1987: *Coverage of the Democratic* and *Republican candidates for the presidential nomination* | 14 | 34 | 37 | 14 | 1 |
| f. Standard and Poor's downgrading the U.S. credit rating | | | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 31 | 27 | 16 | 25 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| August 4-7, 2011: *Congress and the President agreeing to cut federal spending and raise the debt limit* | 46 | 25 | 13 | 14 | 1 |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| July 28-31, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt* | 41 | 27 | 15 | 17 | * |
| July 21-24, 2011 | 38 | 28 | 17 | 17 | * |
| July 14-17, 2011 | 34 | 29 | 18 | 19 | * |
| July 7-10, 2011 | 25 | 30 | 21 | 23 | * |
| June 30-July 3, 2011 | 29 | 30 | 15 | 25 | 2 |
| June 16-19, 2011: *Debate in Washington over whether to raise the federal debt limit* | 24 | 26 | 22 | 28 | * |
| June 2-5, 2011 | 23 | 24 | 22 | 31 | * |
| May 26-29, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit* | 25 | 26 | 20 | 29 | * |
| May 12-15, 2011 | 21 | 26 | 24 | 28 | 1 |
| May 5-8, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt* | 29 | 28 | 22 | 20 | 1 |
| April 21-25, 2011 | 30 | 31 | 18 | 21 | * |
| April 14-17, 2011 | 36 | 27 | 18 | 19 | 1 |
| April 7-10, 2011: *The threat of a government shutdown because of budget disagreements in Washington* | 47 | 26 | 15 | 12 | * |
| March 31-April 3, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit* | 30 | 27 | 21 | 22 | * |
| March 17-20, 2011 | 24 | 25 | 24 | 26 | 1 |
| March 3-6, 2011 | 26 | 29 | 19 | 26 | 1 |
| February 17-20, 2011 | 27 | 30 | 17 | 25 | 1 |
| December 2-5, 2010 | 35 | 25 | 21 | 17 | 2 |
| November 11-14, 2010: *Proposals made by leaders of the federal budget deficit commission* | 15 | 21 | 21 | 41 | 1 |
| January 9-12, 2009: *Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year* | 35 | 30 | 19 | 16 | * |
| November, 1990: *Congressional and administration efforts to reach a budget deficit agreement* | 34 | 33 | 20 | 11 | 2 |
| October, 1990: *Attempts by Congress and the administration to find ways to reduce the budget deficit* | 34 | 37 | 17 | 12 | * |

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

| Aug 11-14 2011 | |
|---|---|
| 27 | The 30 U.S. troops killed in Afghanistan in a helicopter attack |
| 19 | Recent ups and downs in the stock market |
| 10 | Standard and Poor's downgrading the U.S. credit rating |
| 8 | News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections |
| 5 | Riots in London and other parts of Britain |
| 4 | Severe food shortages in Somalia |
| 9 | Some other story **(VOL.)** |
| 17 | Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)** |

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.3 When you see or hear news reports about the economy, does it make you feel… **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

| | Yes | No | (VOL.) DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|
| a. Optimistic | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 28 | 69 | 2 |
| November 14-17, 2008 | 30 | 69 | 1 |
| b. Angry | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 58 | 41 | 1 |
| November 14-17, 2008 | 49 | 50 | 1 |
| c. Depressed | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 33 | 66 | 1 |
| November 14-17, 2008 | 35 | 65 | * |
| d. Confused | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 40 | 59 | 1 |
| November 14-17, 2008 | 37 | 63 | * |
| e. Scared | | | |
| August 11-14, 2011 | 39 | 60 | 1 |
| November 14-17, 2008 | 43 | 57 | * |

PEW.4 Thinking about what you've been reading and hearing in the news recently, what one economic or financial problem have you heard the most about these days? **[OPEN END. DO NOT PROBE FOR ADDITIONAL MENTIONS. IF MORE THAN ONE MENTION, RECORD UP TO THREE RESPONSES IN ORDER OF MENTION]**

| Aug 11-14 2011 | |
|---|---|
| 32 | Deficit/Debt/Government spending/Federal deficit/National debt |
| 14 | Jobs/unemployment |
| 13 | Stock market |
| 7 | U.S. credit rating downgrade/Standard and Poor's (S&P) downgrade |
| 4 | Housing/Mortgages/Foreclosures |
| 3 | Health care/Medicare/Medicaid |
| 2 | Gas prices/Oil prices |
| 2 | Social Security |
| 2 | Recession/Depression |
| 2 | Inflation/Cost of living/Cost of food |
| 1 | Taxes |
| 1 | The political situation/Political gridlock |
| 1 | War(s)/Military spending |
| 1 | Economy (General mentions) |
| 6 | Some other **(SPECIFY)** |
| 4 | None/No problem |
| 9 | Don't know/No answer |

*Figures add to more than 100%.*

**PEW.4 CONTINUED…**

***TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:***

| Nov 14-17 2008 | | June 13-16 2008 | Jan 18-21 2008 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | Housing/Mortgage crisis/Foreclosures/Sub-prime mortgages | 11 | 31 |
| 17 | Auto industry | -- | -- |
| 13 | Government bailout plan | -- | -- |
| 13 | Economy/Economic problems/Financial problems (general) | 7 | 7 |
| 11 | Wall Street banks/Credit crisis/Bank lending practices | 2 | 2 |
| 9 | Stock market | 1 | 6 |
| 7 | Jobs/Unemployment | 2 | 3 |
| 5 | Gas and oil prices | 72 | 7 |
| 2 | Health care/Health care costs/Medicare | 2 | 3 |
| 1 | Recession/Possible Recession | 1 | 14 |
| 1 | Taxes (general) | 1 | 1 |
| 1 | Inflation/Cost of living/Cost of food | 2 | 2 |
| 1 | The war in Iraq/The military | -- | -- |
| 1 | Lagging retail sales/Major retailers losing money | -- | -- |
| 3 | Other | 2 | 6 |
| 2 | None/no problem | 2 | 8 |
| 3 | Don’t know/Refused | 3 | 7 |